

CSS Selectors, Cascading & Specificity Notes

What are CSS Selectors?

CSS selectors are used to target HTML elements and apply styles to them. Selectors help browsers identify which elements should receive specific CSS properties.

Ways to Connect CSS

1. Inline CSS – using style attribute.
2. Internal CSS – using style tag inside head.
3. External CSS – using separate .css file with link tag.

Universal Selector (*)

Targets all HTML elements on the page.

Element Selector

Targets elements using tag names like h1, p, div.

Class Selector (.)

Targets elements using class name. Mostly used in real-time projects.

ID Selector (#)

Targets unique elements using ID names.

Group Selector

Applies same styles to multiple elements together.

Descendant Selector

Targets child elements inside parent elements.

Pseudo-Class Selector

Targets special states like hover, focus, active.

Pseudo-Element Selector

Targets specific part of an element like first-letter or first-line.

What is Cascading?

Cascading means multiple styles can apply to the same element and browser decides which style should win.

What is Specificity?

Specificity is the priority calculation system used by browsers to determine which CSS rule should apply.

Specificity Priority

Inline CSS > ID Selector > Class Selector > Element Selector > Universal Selector

What is !important?

!important overrides normal specificity and gives highest priority to a CSS rule.

Basic Example

```
<h1 class="title" id="heading">Hello</h1> h1{ color:red; } .title{ color:blue; }  
#heading{ color:green; }
```